

‘Nepo Baby’ Was Just the Start: Inside the Expanding Nepo Universe [C2]

Una nuova generazione dei figli delle star di Hollywood sta irrompendo sullo schermo. Si tratta di una classica forma di nepotismo, anche se amplificata e commentata sui social network.



Are all nepo babies really created equal? Should Timothée Chalamet, whose uncle Rodman Flender directed [Leprechaun 2](#), appear on nepo baby listicles that include stars with actually famous family, such as Lily-Rose Depp, Hailey (Baldwin) Bieber, or Sofia Coppola? Outing supposed nepo babies is one of social media's favourite [parlour games](#), and it only grew more popular after becoming the subject of a 2022 New York magazine cover. Dynasties have existed since the [dawn](#) of the star system, but younger generations are more [willing](#) to count an Oscar-winning father or supermodel mother as a [strike](#) against an [up-and-comer](#). Sometimes, there are debates over the title's true definition, as we see with Chalamet or Billie Eilish, whose mom is a television actor and indie screenwriter. But there is a certain category of nepo baby we can all agree on: the double nepo.

THE DOUBLE NEPO BABY

Also known as the full nepo, these kids are progeny of not one but two (and sometimes more) incredibly connected humans. Take Brooklyn Beckham, son of [Posh](#) and Becks, known for his [out-of-focus](#) elephant portraits and being a professional Instagram husband to fellow nepo baby Nicola Peltz, daughter of a billionaire investor. Or the Oppenheimer actor Jack Quaid, the product of Dennis and Meg Ryan's nine-year marriage. Or Dakota Johnson, known for her work [calling out](#) Ellen DeGeneres over a birthday-party [feud](#) — she's not just the daughter of Melanie Griffith and Don Johnson, but also Tippi Hedren's granddaughter. Liv Tyler has a famous mom in Bebe Buell, a famous dad in Steven Tyler, and a famous father figure in Todd Rundgren. There's also Maya Hawke (Ethan and Uma Thurman), Zoë Kravitz (Lenny and Lisa Bonet), Maude Apatow (Judd and Leslie Mann), Willow and Jaden Smith (Will and Jada Pinkett Smith), and Deacon Reese Phillippe (Reese Witherspoon and Ryan Phillippe). The latter recently showed off his opulent "college apartment" during a TikTok house tour. "How much do you pay for rent in New York?" the host asked, to which Philippe replied: "West Village prices, man." For some viewers, that could be translated as: "[Dunno](#), ask Mom and Dad." These kids earn the most online [scorn](#) simply because they had the best chances of success. Sure, many of them are talented. Angelina Jolie has two famous parents and an Oscar. But should double nepos [mess up](#), as Drew Barrymore did when crossing the [picket line](#) to film her talkshow during the writer's [strike](#), this is the first thing [armchair critics](#) point to. The more [self-aware](#) nepo baby might [cop to](#) their privilege. Sean Astin, Allison Williams and Jamie Lee Curtis come to mind, as does Susan Sarandon's [brood](#), all of whom have their own [IMDb](#) pages. Her eldest son with Tim Robbins, Jack, [leaned on](#) his famous [folks](#) with a little [wink-wink](#) when he made a satirical "day in the life of a nepo baby" Instagram video. (Sample joke: "I live in the coolest and most up-and-coming neighbourhood in New York City, the Upper East Side.") Miles, Sarandon's other son with Robbins, recently posted on X thanking fans for supporting his mother, who was [dropped](#) by her talent agency after speaking at a pro-Palestine [rally](#). He had one request, though: "I'm really grateful to see people

on Twitter defending my mom amidst a new era of McCarthyist [blacklisting](#) but can you PLEASE stop using the clip of her [getting her hair done](#) with her [honkers](#) out,” he wrote. Sarandon’s daughter, Eva Amurri (another double nepo, as her father is the Italian film director Franco Amurri), makes no attempt to hide her connections, saying that she grew up alongside other celebrity kids, celebrating birthdays and holidays together. But some full nepos, for all that [networking](#), surprisingly lack [savvy](#) publicists who advise them to embrace their privilege. Instead, they deny their nepo status.

THE EXTENDED NEPO FAMILY

Gwyneth Paltrow, a double nepo baby herself and mother to two of them, called the ‘nepo baby’ term “an ugly [moniker](#).” She might not like to know, then, that there are nepo baby-adjacent figures — such as the nepo boyfriend, a man who [rides on his more celebrated partner’s coattails](#). Jake Bongiovi happens to be one, as [he booked](#) film roles after meeting his now [fiancee](#), Millie Bobby Brown. (The fact that he is also Jon Bon Jovi’s son probably helped, too.) [Ditto](#) for Travis Kelce, though football fans who knew of the [tight end](#) before he [hooked up](#) with Taylor Swift might disagree. After news of their courtship [broke](#), the NFL player enjoyed a [flurry](#) of attention, shooting him from a mere sports figure to internationally known arm candy. Then there are nepo friends, formerly known as an [entourage](#). These [folks](#) are more likely to earn social media followings than real work, though as Time reported in a piece on the phenomenon, Kylie Jenner’s longtime [bestie](#) Anastasia “Stassie” Karanikolaou recently launched a line of vodka. YouTubers like Tana Mongeau and MrBeast have also catapulted their friends (Imari Stuart and Kris Tyson, respectively) to influencer status. Though the traditional beneficiaries of nepotism are [offspring](#), there are nepo parents, too. The TikToker Charli D’Amelio gave her parents the gift of social media superstardom: Heidi and Marc D’Amelio starred in a Hulu docuseries about their lives. It could be argued that Kris Jenner, matriarch of the Kardashian clan, became a nepo parent after Kim [broke](#) through reality TV fame to become one of the most famous faces of our time. Though, of course, Kim and her sisters would never have gotten to capitalize on their fifteen minutes of fame if their [mom-ager](#) hadn’t set it up first for them. And, as the Dallas Observer [delightfully](#) noted in a story on nepo parents, Rob Reiner brilliantly [cast](#) his own mother in the infamous When Harry Met Sally [deli](#) orgasm scene. Sometimes [raw](#) talent transcends nepotism — who else but Estelle could have [delivered](#) “I’ll have what she’s having” that memorably? However, if you didn’t win the Hollywood lineage lottery or [befriend](#) the right people, consider this: you may be a double nepo without knowing it. On TikTok, regular people share how their parents’ unglamorous [gigs come in handy](#). “I’m a double nepotism baby in the best way (i can’t get [jury duty](#) bc my dad was a cop & my mom was in prison),” one user wrote in a video. Or, as another put it: “Both my parents were engineers so I’m fairly certain I could [probs](#) instinctively drive a train or whatever it is they did if I

wanted to.” As the saying goes, you’ve got to network to get work. Published in The Guardian on December 23, 2023. Reprinted with permission.

Glossary

- **out-of-focus** = sfocato
- **scorn** = disprezzo
- **picket line** = picchetto
- **self-aware** = consapevole di sé, conscio di sé
- **bc** = perché (abb. because)
- **brood** = prole
- **networking** = rete di contatti
- **Ditto** = idem
- **flurry** = ondata
- **bestie** = migliore amica
- **offspring** = prole
- **raw** = crudo
- **gigs** = lavori
- **willing** = disposte
- **calling out** = segnalare
- **cop to** = rendersi conto
- **he booked** = ottenere
- **tight end** = estremo stretto (ruolo d'attacco di una squadra di football americano)
- **jury duty** = fare il giurato
- **probs** = probabilmente (abb. probably)
- **dawn** = albori
- **feud** = faida
- **mess up** = incasinare
- **folks** = genitori
- **dropped** = abbandonare
- **blacklisting** = mettere nella lista nera
- **getting her hair done** = pettinarsi
- **rides on his more celebrated partner's coattails** = cavalcare il successo di
- **parlour games** = giochi di società
- **strike** = sciopero
- **leaned on** = appoggiarsi a
- **broke** = anticipare una notizia
- **deli** = ristorante (abb. delicatessen)
- **come in handy** = rivelare utile
- **Posh** = snob
- **armchair critics** = critici da poltrona
- **IMDb** = Internet Movie Database (sito web sui film)
- **rally** = manifestazione
- **mom-ager** = madre-manager

- **cast** = assegnare a
- **Leprechaun** = folletto
- **Dunno** = non sapere (contrazione di I don't know)
- **wink** = occholino
- **savvy** = esperti
- **moniker** = soprannome
- **befriend** = stringere amicizia
- **up-and-comer** = emergente
- **honkers** = seni
- **fiancee** = promessa sposa
- **hooked up** = frequentare
- **entourage** = seguito